Oliver Searle-Barnes

Passionate full stack leader

Founder, CTO, VP Engineering, Architect

20 Years experience

FnCasts - watch me code on youtube

opsb - 200+ repos

opsb - 14 communities

opsb - top 1%

ollysb

oliver@opsb.co.uk

INTRODUCTION

Building software that people actually like to use is what gets me going. With 20 years experience I've delivered successful products for the Telecoms, Retail, Publishing, Energy, Charity, Health and Beauty and Domestic appliance sectors. I've led teams to build a wide variety of projects including realtime social platforms and project management tools, business Intelligence, custom content management systems, online stores and browser extensions.

From day one I've been an agile practitioner, whether it's Scrum or Kanban, Lean, BDD, outside-in, pair-programming, you name it, I've been doing it for years. I've usually led from the front but I'm comfortable working in many different styles and value project consistency over personal preferences so am equally comfortable working alone or slotting into an existing team.

SKILLS

	years
Elixir / Phoenix	7
Ruby on Rails	8
NextJS	2
Elm	5
React	5
Typescript/Javascript	15
Java	6
SQL	20
Firebase	2
OLAP / MDX	4

	years
Event-sourcing/CQRS	2
Scrum / Kanban	18
BDD / TDD	18
Git	15
Realtime systems	7
HTML	21
CSS / SASS	18
OO	20
Functional	10
AWS	12
Terraform	4

OPEN SOURCE

fncasts / fnchess
Paired with a friend on youtube to build a chess game in Elm backend by Phoenix-Channels for realtime. See **https://fncasts.io** for the episodes.

orbitjs / orbit
A javascript library for orchestrating data synchronization. See **http://orbitjs.com** for more information.

saschatimme / elm-phoenix
Integration between Elm and Phoenix channels

opsb / elm-debouncer-fx
An Elm effect manager for debouncing events

opsb / patchstream
Emits json patches as rails active records are updated

opsb / cv-elm
The code used to generate the CV you're reading right now

COMMUNITY

I love to meet other developers and hear what they're getting up to. In Barcelona I'm a regular at the Elixir meetup and run the Elm hack night. I'm also regularly in London and Berlin so I make sure to pop into the local Elixir and Elm meetups there.

Online you'll regularly find me in the Elixir and Elm slacks. I've found both communities to be really friendly and helpful.

EDUCATION

Artificial Intelligence **2/1**
Sussex University 2001-2004

EXPERIENCE

xpflow
Founding Engineer & CPO
Feb 2025-Apr 2026
Dallas / Remote

Alfie (AI affiliate recruitment)
Built Alfie, an AI-powered affiliate partner recruitment platform, shipping the MVP in three weeks and validating strong demand. Scale limits in the on-demand approach informed the company's next phase, now its current focus.
AI/LLMs, NextJS, Postgres

tree3
Consultant
Dec 2023-Feb 2025
Dallas / Remote

XP Affiliate Platform
Led engineering on a high-performance affiliate platform. When the product stalled, ran customer discovery and proposed an AI-powered affiliate recruitment product, spun out as xpflow with me on the founding team.
NextJS, Postgres, Redis

Tastermonial
Consultant
Jun 2023-Nov 2023
Cupertino / Remote

Tastermonial App
Replaced MVP with a high-performance Flutter/Phoenix mobile app, running on AWS with supporting build pipelines.
Elixir, Flutter, Sqlite, Postgres, AWS/Terraform

Boulevard
Consultant
Oct 2021-Jun 2023
Los Angeles / Remote

API and Platform Services
Joined the API team at this health and beauty unicorn to scale platform services and integrations with 3rd party services.
Elixir, Postgres, React, Typescript, AWS/Terraform

Vorwerk
Consultant
Apr 2021-Sep 2021
Wuppertal / Remote

Kobold
Bootstrapped an Elixir/Phoenix team at this global consumer appliance giant to provide cloud services and a Python client for a new line of commercial robot vacuum cleaners.
Elixir, Python, Postgres, AWS/Terraform

CompareTheMarket.com
Consultant
Feb 2019-Present
London / Remote

MoneyHub
Rebuilt Bean.com as a high-performance Elixir service for this leading UK price-comparison site, integrating the majority of high street banks via Open Banking.
Elixir, GraphQL, Elm, Javascript, Ruby, Postgres, AWS

TwentyBN
Consultant
Sep–Nov 2018
Berlin / Remote

Video Annotation Editor
Designed and built two Elm apps to collect video gesture training data from Amazon Mechanical Turk workers for this computer vision AI company.
Elm, Javascript

Liqid
Consultant
Feb–Aug 2018
Berlin / Remote

Salesforce Integration
Built an Elixir/RabbitMQ microservice to integrate this wealth management fintech's Rails app with Salesforce.
Elixir, Ruby on Rails, RabbitMQ, Salesforce, Docker, GraphQL

Zapnito
VP Engineering
2014–2017
London / Remote

Feeds
Led the development of a white-labelled realtime community platform.
Phoenix, Phoenix-Channels, Elixir, Elm, Javascript, JWT, Auth0, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Lytbulb
CTO
2014–2015
London / Remote

lytbulb.com
Led development of a trello-like product aimed at the energy sector, focusing on oil and gas.
Ruby on Rails, Ember.js, Firebase, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Myschooldirect
CTO
2010–2014
London / Remote

Give4Sure
A browser plugin helping shoppers raise money for their chosen charities.
Browser extensions, Ruby on Rails, Postgres, Ember.js, Kanban, BDD

Marks and Spencer School Uniforms
An online store for schools to create their own Marks and Spencer uniforms.
Ruby on Rails, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

myschooldirect.com
A Quidco style site helpers shoppers raise money for their children's school.
Ruby on rails, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Informa
Tech lead/Architect
2005-2010
London

World Cellular Information Service
Led team to develop a replacement for Informa Telecom's flagship product.
Java, Spring, MS Analytics services, Oracle DB, Scrum, TDD

World Broadband Information Service
Developed a BI portal based on the Mondrian OLAP engine.
Java, Spring, OLAP, Mondrian, Oracle DB, Scrum, TDD

Intelligence Centre 2
Devised a webdav based CMS allowing Journalists to edit articles in MS Word.
Java/Spring, Oracle DB, Scrum, BDD